PIHOCO

FREE GUIDE · MENU ENGINEERING

The January *menu reset.*

Ten checks to run before you reprint the menu for the new year. No software needed: a sales report, your supplier invoices and an hour with your head chef.

Ten checks, *in this order.*

01 **Re-cost your top ten sellers**

Use this month's supplier invoices, not last year's recipe card. Prices drift faster than menus, and the best sellers carry the most risk.

02 **Rank by contribution, not food-cost %**

Contribution is the cash a dish leaves after food cost. A dish at 35% food cost can leave more cash per plate than one at 25%.

03 **Find the dishes that do neither**

Mark the items in the bottom of the list for both sales and contribution. Rework them, move them to specials, or retire them.

04 **Put your best earner where the eye lands**

The top of each section, and the first item guests see on a board, get chosen most. Give that spot to a dish that earns, and box it.

05 **Quiet the prices**

Drop currency signs and the dotted lines that lead the eye to the price. Let guests choose the dish, then see the price.

06 **Give each section an anchor**

One premium item at the top of a section makes the next one down feel like the sensible choice.

07 **Count the choices**

If a section can't be read in one glance, it is too long. Fewer choices mean faster orders and less prep.

08 **Price delivery on its own**

Commission, packaging and bags come off every delivery order. Dine-in prices rarely cover them.

09 **Load-test the kitchen**

Find the one dish that slows the busiest station at peak. Simplify its spec before you promote anything.

10 **Brief the floor**

Choose three dishes you want sold and give staff one line for each. A recommendation sells more than a menu redesign.

WANT A SECOND PAIR OF EYES?

Send us your menu for a free scorecard.

A one-page review by our founder, a former hotel sous chef, within two working days.

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